

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

What's in a Footballer's Brain?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Modern players are faster, but the game also demands _____.
2	Players make choices under the _____ and intensities.
3	Compared with that of similar players, Neymar's brain showed _____ when he moved his ankle.
4	This pattern showed his _____ in moving his feet.
5	Clubs are showing growing interest in _____.
6	If players cannot store much information, coaches may make them feel mentally _____.
7	This challenge is introduced in a _____, such as training.
8	Control of a player's emotional state can be _____.
9	Excessive emotion may reduce _____.
10	Before penalties, corners and free kicks, players are taught to _____.

11 **Which new performance factor are some football clubs examining?**

- A The physical speed needed throughout a match
- B The athletic demands created by modern competitions
- C The mental activity involved in rapid, pressured decisions
- D The passion that makes football attractive to supporters

12 **What did the 2014 study observe when Neymar moved his right ankle?**

- A His brain showed less activity than the brains of comparable players.
- B His brain reacted more slowly than those of comparable players.
- C His foot moved more accurately than those of comparable players.
- D His emotional response was weaker than those of comparable players.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **According to the neuroscientist, what did Neymar's reduced cortical activity indicate?**
- A He was protecting his brain from the pressure of competition.
 - B He was relying mainly on his emotional control during movement.
 - C He needed less physical energy than other professional players.
 - D He had mastered the movement so well that little conscious effort was needed.
- 14 **How may coaches respond when players struggle to hold a large amount of information?**
- A They remove complex decisions until the players enter a competition.
 - B They deliberately overload the players during a safe training session.
 - C They measure the players' brainwaves after every difficult exercise.
 - D They replace cognitive practice with sessions focused on physical speed.
- 15 **What contrast is central to the training approach described?**
- A Players face controlled mental overload in training so they may improve in real matches.
 - B Players practise without pressure before facing identical tasks in cup competitions.
 - C Players first develop physically and then begin separate neurological training.
 - D Players store match information but avoid using it during practice sessions.
- 16 **What view is expressed about the emotional side of performance?**
- A It matters only during set pieces such as penalties and corners.
 - B It is fixed by personality and therefore difficult for coaching to change.
 - C It strongly influences performance but can be brought under greater control.
 - D It becomes useful only when players stop making conscious decisions.
- 17 **What is the likely effect of having too much emotion during play?**
- A It helps a player act automatically with less mental effort.
 - B It makes accurate and concentrated play more difficult.
 - C It allows a player to manage larger amounts of information.
 - D It increases the value of physical training over brain training.
- 18 **Why are penalties, corners and free kicks especially suitable for focused mental coaching?**
- A They are the only occasions when emotions affect a player's performance.
 - B They require players to store more information than any other match situation.
 - C They allow brain activity to stop briefly before physical movement begins.
 - D They provide brief pauses in which players can manage their mental state.

- 19 **What is the purpose of mentioning difficulty in delivering an accurate corner?**
- A To illustrate how scattered attention can weaken execution at a decisive moment
 - B To prove that corners are mentally harder than penalties and free kicks
 - C To show that brainwave measurement directly improves kicking technique
 - D To suggest that technical ability becomes irrelevant in high-pressure situations
- 20 **What overall implication can be drawn from the discussion of small margins?**
- A Brain training can remove the uncertainty from close football matches.
 - B Emotional control matters more than skill in determining every match result.
 - C Only major neurological changes are likely to affect competitive performance.
 - D Small gains in focus may have an important effect on the final outcome.